

Korean Ceramics Record Normalization

A cross-institution demonstration of turning public object records into a consistent working schema

Problem

Collection information often arrives in mixed formats: prose descriptions, inconsistent titles, different dimension strings, institution-specific classification terms, and partial source notes. A working spreadsheet needs predictable fields without erasing the original record.

Normalized fields

- Record ID
- Institution
- Canonical title
- Culture / dynasty
- Date / period
- Material / technique
- Dimensions
- Accession number
- Location / department
- Source URL
- Research note

Normalization rules

- Preserve institutional titles and accession numbers exactly.
- Normalize punctuation and dimension syntax, but retain every explicit measurement.
- Do not infer provenance, attribution, technique, or object type when the source is silent.
- Keep one source URL per working row so every normalized field can be audited.
- Flag ambiguity in a research-note field rather than resolving it by guess.

Included workbook

The accompanying XLSX contains six verified public museum records from the National Museum of Korea and The Metropolitan Museum of Art, plus a field guide explaining the normalization choices.

[National Museum of Korea - Moon Jar record](https://www.museum.go.kr/ENG/contents/E0402000000.do?relicId=8586&schM;=view)

<https://www.museum.go.kr/ENG/contents/E0402000000.do?relicId=8586&schM;=view>

[The Metropolitan Museum of Art - Moon jar](https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/45432)

<https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/45432>

[The Metropolitan Museum of Art - Jar with lid](https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/851661)

<https://www.metmuseum.org/art/collection/search/851661>

Client workflow

- Define a minimum schema before touching the data.
- Preserve original identifiers and source links.
- Normalize only what can be normalized without losing meaning.
- Create an exceptions list for records that require a curator or client decision.

Scope note

This is a demonstration dataset. It is designed to show clean data practice, not to replace institutional catalogue records.